

Marketing Detective — Case Report

SOLVED

Case number	MD-1000
Company	Lumen & Oak Skincare
Industry	D2C Beauty / Skincare
Campaign objective	Drive first-time purchases of a new retinol serum through paid social.
Target audience	Women aged 25-40 interested in clean beauty and skincare routines.

Campaign metrics

Reach	1.2M
Ctr	0.4%
Engagement	2.1%
Conversions	312
Sales	\$9,360

PRIME SUSPECT IDENTIFIED

Broken mobile checkout experience

Supporting clues

Clue A: CTR is unusually low (0.4%) despite strong reach and creative engagement, suggesting an attention problem exists after the click, not before it.

Clue B: Multiple customer comments independently mention slow load times and a confusing path to the product page on mobile.

Clue C: 92% of ad traffic was mobile, but the site's conversion rate on mobile is less than a third of desktop.

Investigator's explanation

The creative and targeting were working well, generating strong reach and social engagement. The campaign failed because the mobile landing experience was slow and disorienting, causing interested users to abandon before completing a purchase. The budget was optimized for attention, not for the point of friction that was actually losing customers.

Suggested improvements

1. Audit and optimize mobile page load speed before scaling any paid spend.
2. Simplify the path from ad click to product page to a single tap.
3. Display price and shipping cost upfront to reduce checkout abandonment.

Marketing Detective — all companies, campaigns, and figures referenced are fictional and created for instructional purposes only.